

Background & Literature Review

~4,800 words · rubric weight 20% (heaviest)

DEFINITION

A critical synthesis organised by theme, building to the gap — not an author-by-author catalogue.

KEY POINTS

- Group sources by idea and debate, not by author
- Evaluate quality, method and limits critically
- Cite seminal originators, not only recent summaries
- Converge on the gap that justifies your questions

REFERENCE

Hart, C. (2018) *Doing a Literature Review*. 2nd edn. London: SAGE.